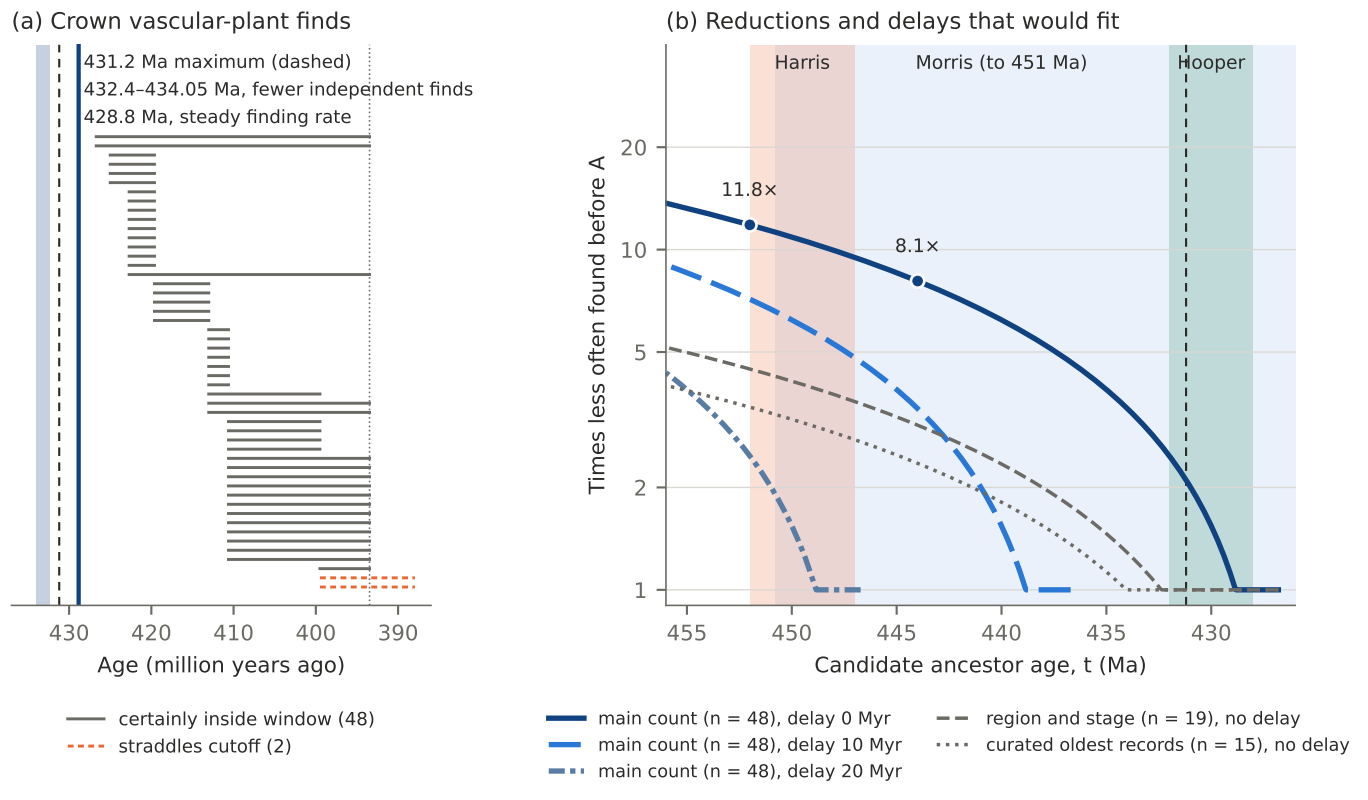
(a) Crown vascular-plant finds
431.2 Ma maximum (dashed)
432.4–434.05 Ma, fewer independent finds
428.8 Ma, steady finding rate
430
420
410
400
390
Age (million years ago)
certainly inside window (48)
straddles cutoff (2)
(b) Reductions and delays that would fit
Harris
Morris (to 451 Ma)
Hooper
11.8×
8.1×
Times less often found before A
20
10
5
2
1
455
450
445
440
435
430
Candidate ancestor age, t (Ma)
main count (n = 48), delay 0 Myr
main count (n = 48), delay 10 Myr
main count (n = 48), delay 20 Myr
region and stage (n = 19), no delay
curated oldest records (n = 15), no delay